

Yong Da Li

yongli@ethz.ch

EDUCATION

ETH Zürich

Sept 2023 – May 2026 (expected)

Master's in Electrical Engineering and Information Technology

Zürich, Switzerland

Thesis: Adaptive energy grid for quantum transport simulator

Supervisor: Prof. Mathieu Luisier

Cumulative grade: 5.3/6.0

University of Toronto

Sept 2018 – May 2023

Bachelor of Applied Science in Engineering Science

Toronto, Canada

Major: Engineering Physics

Thesis: Hierarchical matrix methods for solving boundary element problems

Supervisor: Prof. Piero Triverio

Cumulative grade: 3.74/4.00

EXPERIENCE – WORK AND ACADEMIC

ETH Zürich – Institute of Electromagnetic Fields

Fall 2024

Semester project with Prof. Leuthold (supervisor Dr. Mario Kupresak)

- Implemented 1-D discontinuous Galerkin finite element method model of semiconductor hydrodynamic equations (energy-balance model)
- Achieved results comparable to industry tools Synopsys TCAD and Silvaco ATLAS

ETH Zürich - Millimeter-Wave Electronics Laboratory

Spring 2024

Semester project with Prof. Bolognesi (supervisor Dr. Sara Hamzeloui)

- Parametric optimization of substrate transmission lines targeting in-house double heterojunction bipolar transistor
- Proposed additional metal routing layer to reduce attenuation loss by 50%

Altera (formerly Intel)

Sept 2022 – Sept 2023

Altera FPGA Virtual Platforms and Solutions intern (part-time)

Toronto, Canada

- Developed DevOps infrastructure for the simulation platform of next generation FPGA products
- Tested common customer uses on simulation platform to ensure error-free behavior

University of Toronto - Modelics Lab

May 2022 – Sept 2022

Summer research student with Prof. Piero Triverio

Toronto, Canada

- Investigated the use of hierarchical matrix libraries to accelerate direct solve of dense matrices generated from method of moments formulation
- Continued into 4th year undergraduate thesis

Altera (formerly Intel)***May 2021 – May 2022***

Altera FPGA Software Program Management intern

Toronto, Canada

- Represented software organization at cross-department reviews and meetings.
- Successfully oversaw software support completion for Intel's 1st generation structure ASIC device
- Managed tracking of requirements, bugs, and change requests on internal tool
- Created and managed the initial software engineering timeline for next-generation hybrid FPGA and structured ASIC product
- Trained 6 full-time new hires and 3 new interns as the team doubled in size

University of Toronto – Helmy Photonics Lab***May 2020 – Sept 2020***

Summer research student with Prof. Amr Helmy

Toronto, Canada

- Simulated asymmetric hybrid plasmonic waveguides in Lumerical Mode Solutions
- Reported mode-coupling and exception points by sweeping design parameters

National University of Singapore – Smart Solar Systems Lab***May 2019 – Aug 2019***

Summer exchange research student with Prof. Ho Ghim Wei

Singapore

- Synthesized TiO₂ nanofibres with silver nanoparticles by electrospinning process
- Tested effectiveness of synthesized material for water evaporation and H₂ gas production

AWARDS

NSERC Undergraduate Student Research Award (ECE department)	2022
Kenneth C. Smith Award in Engineering Science	2021
Engineering Science Research Fellowship (ESROP)	2020
*NSERC Undergraduate Student Research Award (ECE department)	2020
*NSERC Undergraduate Student Research Award (Astronomy department)	2020
*Summer Undergraduate Research Program (Astronomy Department)	2020
Engineering Science Research Fellowship (international exchange)	2019
Faculty of Engineering Admission Scholarship	2018
Kiwanis Club of East York Scholarship	2018

*awards were declined due to University of Toronto policy, recipients can only accept 1 summer research award per summer.

EXPERIENCE – DESIGN TEAMS***University of Toronto Aerospace Team – Space Systems******Mar 2020 - current***

Payload Electronics lead

Toronto, Canada

- Team goal: design, build, and launch a 3U hyperspectral remote sensing CubeSat
- Lead and train a team of ~5-10 undergraduate students in embedded systems and electro-mechanical design
- Built and tested firmware modules using the STM32 ecosystem for I2C, CAN-FD, SDMMC, DCMI-via-DMA, FreeRTOS
- Currently finishing ARM math-optimized hyperspectral compression algorithm based on CCSDS123 and high-redundancy Earth-to-orbit firmware upgrade capability

- Architect the inter-system communication protocol onboard the satellite
- Selected and acquired infrared camera module to meet mission performance, mass, volume, power, cost, and legal constraints

University of Toronto Aerospace Team – Space Systems ***Nov 2021 - current***
 Lab Space Manager and Finance Director Toronto, Canada

- Negotiated and signed lease to a permanent lab space for the team
- Currently in talks with the engineering faculty to move into a better space
- Create yearly budgets ~\$200,000
- Enforce good budget and documentation practices (especially for younger members)
- Coordinate design timeline with budget projections for the satellite mission life

University of Toronto Aerospace Team – Space Systems ***Sept 2018 – March 2020***
 Electrical, software, and microfluidics member Toronto, Canada

- Designed, built, and tested battery tab spot welder
- Built and tested SPI module for payload instrument subsystem data collection
- Created system communication breakout/pass-through PCB and machined aluminum interface plate for use in successful thermal-vacuum chamber testing
- Prototyped and finalized burst plate design for in-house microfluidic chips
- Integrated final flight-version biology payload into microfluidic assembly, in ISO-6 cleanroom

EXTRA-CURRICULARS

Zürich Ultimate Frisbee Club ***Nov 2025 – present***
 Co-captain of ZebraH (mixed gender team)

Intramural Sports ***Sept 2020 – Sept 2023***
 Engineering Volleyball Captain

- Lead logistics for the 8-10 faculty affiliated student volleyball teams
- Organize tryouts for 200+ people

University of Toronto Campus Philharmonic Orchestra ***Sept 2018 – March 2020***
 2nd Flute

- Performed 2x per year, playing popular orchestral music

Toronto Youth Symphonic Winds ***Sept 2015 – May 2018***
 1st Flute

- Performed 3x per year, playing mostly contemporary wind orchestra music

Key Club ***April 2017 – April 2018***
 Eastern Canada District Governor

- Student head of volunteering, service, and leadership club for Ontario, Quebec, and maritime provinces (total ~40 schools, 1500 members)
- Organized annual 3-day annual convention in Halifax
- Represented Canada at the 2017 and 2018 Key Club international convention

PUBLICATIONS

FINCH mission team. *FINCH: A Blueprint for Accessible and Scientifically Valuable Remote Sensing Satellite Missions*. 2022 Small Satellite Conference.

FINCH mission team. *Inspiring the Next Generation: Challenges and Strategies for Onboarding and Retention in an Undergraduate CubeSat Design Team*. 2021 Small Satellite Conference.

HERON mission team. *HERON: Demonstrating a Novel Biological Platform for Small Satellite Missions*. 2021 Small Satellite Conference.